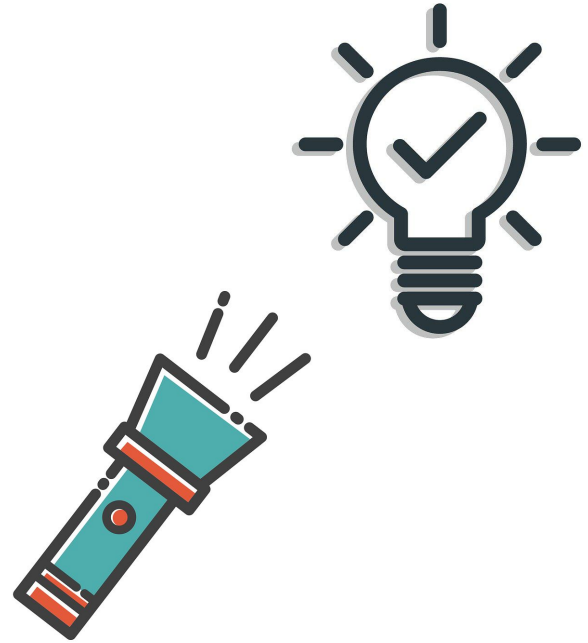


Lesson 4: Identifying a claim

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26

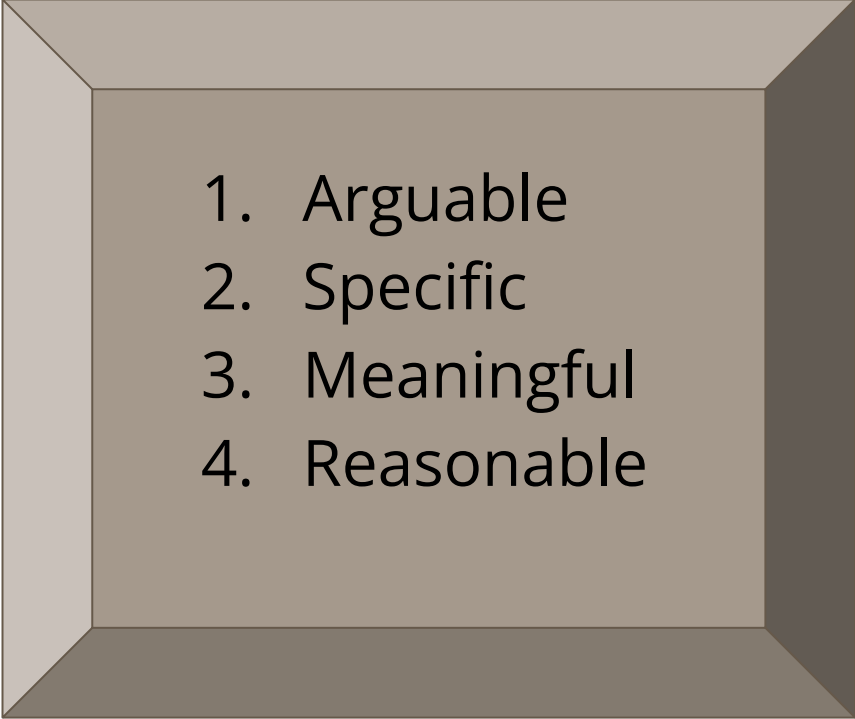


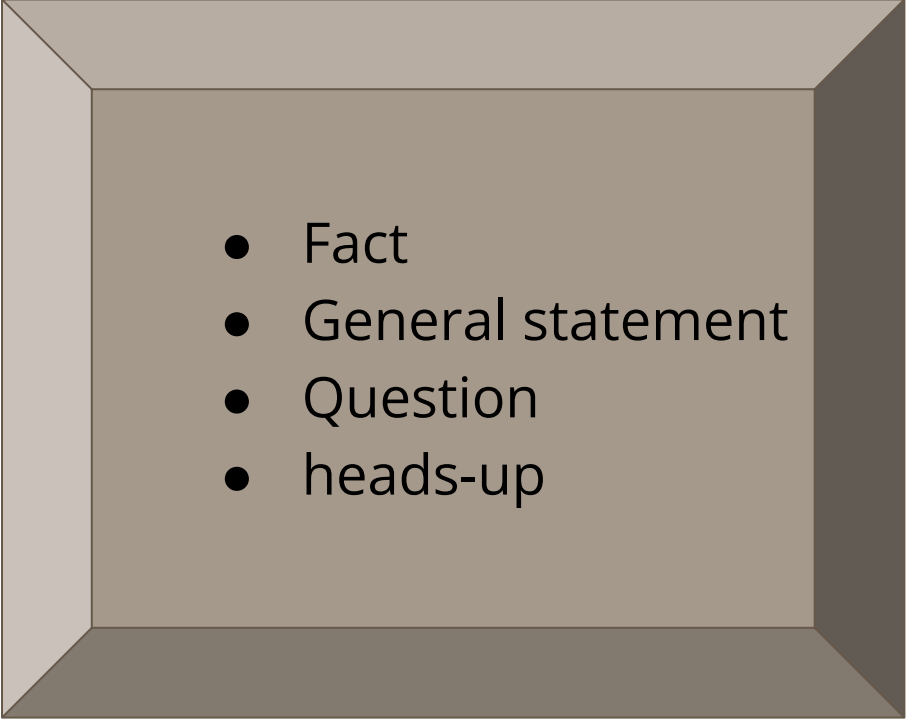
Warm-up

Fill in the chart.

A good claim/thesis statement is ...	A thesis statement is not a...
   	   

A thesis statement is ... and is not a ...

- 
1. Arguable
 2. Specific
 3. Meaningful
 4. Reasonable

- 
- Fact
 - General statement
 - Question
 - heads-up

A better example of thesis statement? Why?

- a. Without a doubt, technology has changed our lives in a big way.
- b. Technology has provided us with ease and expedience, but oftentimes convenient devices dominate our lives in the way of distracting us from other meaningful work.

Today's learning objective

**Identify a central idea
from the text**

Finding the claim(s)

Now that you have basic ideas about a claim and a thesis statement in argumentative writing, let's look at tips and tricks for finding a thesis, or main ideas of a text.

Steps for finding a thesis in an academic paper

1. Read the title.
2. Read the abstract and find 1-2 lines of main claim.
3. See if the the finding of step 2 sounds consistent with the title (step 1)
4. Proceed to the introduction, find paragraphs for Hook, Transition, and the main message
5. If you could find the paragraph(s) containing the main claim, identify the thesis statement(s) and brief supporting/exemplifying elaboration.
6. If you find things uncertain...

If no...

make sure the steps are followed well.

Closely look at the last 1-2 paragraphs of the introduction—the main ideas are usually presented within the range.

- Could you have some clue?
- Is the main idea of the text **hidden**, **indirectly addressed**, or **partially missing** there?

Clues from the supporting detail

Presented supporting details could help you identify the focus or point of the text.

For example, let's take a text containing the following sentence, *"60% of people prefer concerts over going to the movies"*.

It is possible that a topic or central point is related to concert/movie or people's choice of entertainment.

Statistics
Research findings
Claims
Facts
General statements
Examples
Expert opinions

Pair activity



1. Read a short journal article:

- Ed O'Brien (2019)

“Enjoy It Again: Repeat Experiences Are Less Repetitive Than People Think”

in Journal of Personality and Social Psychology 116(4)

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1TfkZ-Wzr9WIOsUI1kX-3VIBdft6XsSwK/>

- ## 2. Read the abstract and find a main claim (i.e., thesis statement).
- ## 3. Read the introduction and find the (part of) paragraph that has a main message and brief details.

Steps for finding a thesis in an academic paper

1. Read the title.
2. Read the abstract and find 1-2 lines of main claim.
3. See if the the finding of step 2 sounds consistent with the title (step 1)
4. Proceed to the introduction, find paragraphs for Hook, Transition, and the main message
5. If you could find the paragraph(s) containing the main claim, identify the thesis statement(s) and brief supporting/exemplifying elaboration.

Pairify

Form a group of 2 pairs to compare and consolidate the pairs' findings.

- Present your group's identified main claim/thesis statement and why you choose it.

Come to an agreement with all members about whether the thesis meets all requirements (A-S-M-R).

Recall: How did you identify the thesis?

Debrief

What main idea(s) did you collectively identify?

Were the ideas overtly presented, hidden, or partially missing?

Which 'clue' was the most helpful in identification? Why?

Today's second learning objective

Identify explicit versus implicit theses

Explicit vs. implicit ways of presenting the claim

Some thesis statements are easy to identify and others are more complicated because they are implied rather than directly stated.

An explicit thesis statement “directly states the writer’s main idea/position and provides a clear direction.”

An implicit thesis “is not directly stated, but rather suggested through the writer’s ideas and supporting points. Nonetheless, [the writer] should still provide an obvious focus for the reader.”

Example of explicit thesis

... Carnatic music is the most emotional and complex type of Indian music, using improvisation and the range of the human voice to showcase raga bhava. ...

Recall that an explicit thesis (1) directly states the author's position and (2) provides a clear direction. In our sample thesis, you will see both (1) and (2).

Carnatic music is the most emotional and complex type of Indian music, using improvisation and the range of the human voice to showcase raga bhava.

Example of implicit thesis

Review of Jabra Elite 3 Wireless Earphones

Jabra Elite 3's new design is sharper than its previous model. The headset does not feel premium due to the material that reflects its lower price, but it looks reasonably good for the price. The earpieces have a proper in-canal fit, and the controls are through a physical button on each earpiece. Passive noise isolation on the earphones is remarkable thanks to the snug fit. The charging case is simple but functional with a magnetic lid, an indicator light at the front, and a USB Type-C port for charging. The controls on the earpieces are not customisable but cover all important functions. With the controller, you can directly adjust volume, control playback, invoke the default voice assistant on your smartphone, and answer or reject calls.

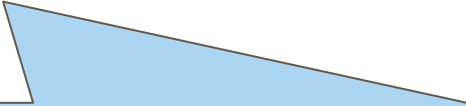
What points does the author make?

Materials aren't fancy, but good for the price.

Fit well and sound good.

Charging case is simple but works.

Controls aren't customizable, but all the important controls are there.



Although the finishing is low-budget and functions are limited, Jabra Elite 3 earphones satisfies essential functions in terms of sound quality, charging, and control.

Comparison

Explicit thesis...	Implicit thesis...
❑ Directly states the author's position ❑ Provides direction overtly ❑ A.S.M.R.	❑ Suggests the author's position ❑ Indirectly stated ❑ A.S.M.R.

You know how to identify an explicit thesis, but if you are struggling to identify an implicit thesis, recall the clues you learned during the beginning of the class.

Are there specific statistics, claims, examples, or expert opinions you can identify that would help you to identify the thesis?

Identifying an implicit thesis

Use the following checklist to help you identify an implicit thesis. Go through the list in order.

Read the entire text, summarize in 1 to 2 sentences, re-read if necessary.

Supporting details can be found in the text (statistics, examples, etc.). Highlight them, or write a few quick notes on what the author is arguing.

Summarize the focuses comprehensive and make them A.S.M.R.